

Company Car Driver Safety Requirements

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Company	Northstar Solutions Ltd.
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1. Purpose and authority

This sub-directive defines the operational controls required by Section 7 of the Company Car Policy. It supplements the parent directive and does not replace it. Authorized drivers must comply with both documents.

If a requirement appears inconsistent with the parent directive, the driver must obtain written guidance from Fleet Management before driving. Applicable law always takes precedence.

2. Scope

This sub-directive applies to every employee and other person authorized to drive an assigned Northstar Solutions company car. The fitness-to-drive, vehicle-condition, distraction, passenger, and security requirements apply during both business and permitted private use.

Journey-planning and working-time controls apply specifically to business travel. Pool vehicles and short-term rentals remain subject to their separate operating procedures.

3. Authorization and driver competence

Before receiving a vehicle, a driver must:

- provide a valid license for the relevant vehicle category;
- disclose license restrictions that affect safe or lawful vehicle use;

- complete the company's defensive-driving course; and

• confirm acceptance of the Company Car Policy and this sub-directive.

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Fleet Management verifies driving authorization at assignment and at least once each year. Drivers must repeat defensive-driving training every two years. Fleet Management may require earlier refresher training after a serious incident, repeated safety alerts, or a material change in driving duties.

A driver whose license is expired, suspended, revoked, or no longer valid for the assigned vehicle must stop driving immediately and notify Fleet Management and their manager.

4. Fitness to drive

A driver must be physically and mentally fit to operate the vehicle safely. Drivers must not drive:

- after consuming alcohol during the working day or a business journey;
- while affected by illegal drugs, misused medication, or any substance that impairs alertness or judgment;
- when illness, stress, or fatigue makes safe driving doubtful; or
- after a healthcare professional has advised against driving.

An employee taking prescribed or over-the-counter medication must review its driving warning and seek medical or pharmacy advice when uncertain. The employee need not disclose a diagnosis, but must tell their manager if a temporary adjustment to driving duties is required.

For business journeys, drivers must plan a break of at least 15 minutes after each two hours of driving. Company driving should not exceed nine hours in any 24-hour period. A longer journey requires a documented journey risk assessment approved by the employee's manager before departure.

No manager may instruct or pressure an employee to continue driving when the employee believes it is unsafe.

5. Vehicle checks

Before the first journey of the day, the driver must complete a visual check appropriate to the vehicle, including:

- tires, wheels, lights, windows, mirrors, and number plates;
- visible fluid leaks or new body damage;
- dashboard warnings and the indicated fuel or battery range;
- charging cables and adapters, where applicable; and
- legally required safety or emergency equipment.

The assigned driver must also complete the digital safety inspection in the Fleet Portal each month and before a business journey longer than 250 kilometers when the latest inspection is more than seven days old.

The driver must not sign an inspection as complete without performing it.

6. Distraction and mobile devices

A driver must not hold, type on, view, or otherwise operate a mobile device while the vehicle is moving or temporarily stopped in traffic. Navigation, music, climate settings, and business applications should be configured before departure or after parking safely.

Hands-free calls must be kept brief and ended if traffic or weather requires greater concentration. Drivers must not join video meetings, read messages, or take notes while driving, even through a hands-free system.

7. Speed, restraint, and driving behavior

Drivers must comply with posted limits and reduce speed further when road, traffic visibility, or weather conditions require it. Seat belts must be used by every occupant whenever the vehicle is moving.

Aggressive driving, racing, deliberate wheel spin, unsafe overtaking, and retaliatory behavior are prohibited. Safety takes priority over appointment, delivery, and meeting times.

8. Weather and journey planning

Before a business journey, the driver must consider the route, forecast, charging or refueling options, expected rest stops, and known restrictions. Fleet Management instructions concerning winter tires, snow chains, high winds, flooding, extreme heat, or other seasonal risks are mandatory.

A driver must postpone, reroute, or stop a journey when conditions cannot be managed safely. The driver must notify the relevant manager or meeting contact as soon as practicable.

9. Passengers, children, and cargo

The driver is responsible for ensuring that:

- the number of occupants does not exceed the vehicle's approved capacity;
- every passenger uses an available seat belt;
- children use a legally compliant restraint appropriate to their size;
- luggage, equipment, and charging cables are secured against movement; and
- no item obstructs windows, mirrors, controls, airbags, or emergency exits.

Dangerous goods, unusually heavy loads, roof carriers, trailers, and modified equipment require prior Fleet Management approval unless ordinary private use is expressly allowed by the assignment letter.

10. Security and parking

When leaving the vehicle, the driver must close windows, lock the vehicle, take the key or access device, and avoid leaving confidential documents or valuable equipment visible. Keys and fleet cards must not be stored together in an unattended location.

The vehicle must not be left running while unattended. Overnight parking should use the assigned secure location where one is available. A lost key, charging card, fuel card, registration document, or access device must be reported to Fleet Management immediately.

11. Defects and stop-use conditions

The driver must stop using the vehicle and contact roadside assistance or Fleet Management when a defect may affect:

- brakes, steering, tires, wheel security, or vehicle stability;
- required lights or visibility;
- occupant restraints or airbags;
- a high-voltage battery or charging connection; or
- any red dashboard warning or instruction to stop.

Other defects must be reported through the Fleet Portal before the next journey. A driver must not disable a safety system, clear a warning to conceal a fault, or continue driving a vehicle that has been marked out of service.

12. Safety events and near misses

Accidents, theft, vandalism, breakdowns, and material damage must be handled under Section 8 of the Company Car Policy. This sub-directive does not change the parent directive's 12-hour reporting deadline.

A near miss that could reasonably have caused injury or significant damage must be reported in the Fleet Portal within 24 hours. Fleet Management may use the report to correct vehicle, route, training, or procedural risks. Good-faith reporting of a safety concern will not by itself result in disciplinary action.

13. Responsibilities

Drivers are responsible for safe decisions, required checks, timely reporting, and cooperation with training or incident reviews.

Managers are responsible for realistic travel schedules, alternatives to driving when risk is excessive, and ensuring that employees are not encouraged to breach this sub-directive.

Fleet Management is responsible for vehicle standards, training records, maintenance controls, roadside support, and safety communications. Occupational Health and Safety reviews trends and recommends preventive action.

14. Records and privacy

Fleet Management retains license-verification and training records for the assignment period plus five years. Digital inspection and near-miss records are retained for 24 months unless they relate to an open investigation or a longer period is required by law.

Vehicle and driver data is accessed and protected under Section 10 of the Company Car Policy.

15. Non-compliance and exceptions

A serious or repeated breach may result in temporary suspension of driving authorization, corrective training, withdrawal of the vehicle, recovery of documented costs, or disciplinary action.

An operational exception requires a written risk assessment and approval from the Head of Fleet Management and the Head of Occupational Health and Safety. No exception may waive applicable law or permit driving while impaired, unlicensed, or dangerously fatigued.